

Philipp Hilbert. *Platform product manager for content infrastructure at scale.*

Positioning, I have 13 years shipping platform and data products in regulated, multi-stakeholder environments, and I am ready to do the same for Sanoma Learning's Content as a Service layer.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY SANOMA LEARNING

Sanoma Learning is solving a real infrastructure problem: how do you give 25 million students across 12 countries access to consistently enriched, semantically tagged content through reliable APIs, without rebuilding the same pipe in every market? That is a platform problem, not a content problem, and it is the kind of work I find most interesting. The phrase "efficient onboarding of content from diverse source systems" in the job description maps directly to the ETL and metadata enrichment work I did at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, where I owned the pipeline that brought in quarterly labour-market data from heterogeneous sources. *That is the kind of problem I have already solved, and I want to do it at a larger scale.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo specs and refactors
- **GitHub Copilot**, coding assistance
- **Cursor**, editor-integrated AI work
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, research and drafting
- **Dagster**, data pipeline orchestration

- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations
-

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Kafka, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built to zero with LLM agents across the funnel.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides of the hire until commitment is confirmed.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, with LLM agents handling top-of-funnel qualification.
 - Funnel and conversion tracking built in SQL; one person runs the day-to-day.
 - Demonstrates ability to own end-to-end platform architecture, multi-sided data flows, and API-driven automation, directly relevant to CaaS delivery.
-

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT SANOMA LEARNING

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

I would talk to downstream product teams in at least three markets to understand how they consume content today, where the API falls short, and which metadata gaps block their roadmaps, so I walk into week two with a real picture of unmet need rather than assumptions.

WEEK 2

Slice and prioritise.

I would take what I heard and draft a ranked backlog of the highest-friction gaps, validate the ranking with engineering and country leads, and make the trade-offs visible in a single shared document so stakeholders stop asking the same questions.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

I would pick the highest-value item that is small enough to release in the next sprint, get it out, and instrument it, because a working release rhythm builds trust faster than any roadmap slide.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Sanoma Learning team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role on your Content as a Service platform. I have 13 years of experience owning platform and data products in complex, multi-stakeholder environments, and the work Sanoma Learning is doing, building a shared content infrastructure that lets downstream teams across 12 countries ship faster, is exactly the kind of product problem I want to work on next.

At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned the national labour-market analytics platform from end to end. I introduced Dagster and dbt to replace a fragile manual import process: quarterly data updates that previously required hand-holding now ran without intervention, cutting update time by roughly 75%. I also drove a full ETL migration and a UI relaunch while simultaneously migrating the system from bare-metal to containers. That combination of pipeline ownership, metadata discipline, and release planning across competing workstreams is close to what the CaaS role describes.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, working with 15+ engineers and data scientists across multinational teams. I championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, which cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable. I also redirected the product strategy based on workflow instrumentation: the UI-led approach recorded zero clicks, and the developer-code-first alternative drove a 200% increase in pipeline runs. That kind of data-informed decision-making is something I apply to every prioritisation call.

Across those roles and my own ventures, including co-founding Qcrypt AG and building the construct8 marketplace, I have worked with content models, APIs, ETL pipelines, semantic enrichment, and cross-functional teams that include engineering, data science, legal, and

commercial stakeholders. I am familiar with LLM-assisted content enrichment and I actively work with agentic workflows in my own projects. The AI and metadata enrichment angle in the CaaS roadmap is an area I can contribute to immediately, not just support from the sidelines.

I work well in matrix organisations. My default is to get the relevant people in a room, make the trade-offs visible, and reach a decision rather than escalating. I am based in Berlin, hold German citizenship, and am available within four weeks.

I would be glad to talk through how my experience maps to the CaaS roadmap.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership across platform, data, and API-driven products in regulated industries. I define product vision and roadmaps, lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery, and own end-to-end releases from discovery through post-launch optimisation. I have shipped data pipelines, ETL migrations, AI platform capabilities, and B2B SaaS products in matrix organisations where engineering, data science, legal, and commercial teams all have a seat at the table.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
- On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
- Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
- I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.

§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable across multinational teams.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Spearheaded development of the AI and data platform for FCAS, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt to replace manual quarterly imports, saving ~75% of time per data update and making new indicators self-serve.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same release period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut an undeliverable roadmap to the top 10% of features: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government. Secure data platform; identity management for RKI programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware; still in production. Managed backlog, user stories, and acceptance criteria in Jira.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019 - 12/2019

- Wind energy; full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

- Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - PRESENT

- Construction staffing B2B marketplace built zero to one alone, with LLM agents across the funnel and SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile P2P payments. Built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Management: product vision and product roadmap, epics, continuous discovery, prioritisation, MVP definition, release planning, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Platform and Data: REST APIs, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, data pipeline design, metadata and taxonomy, API and microservices product ownership.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, agile release trains, PI planning, CI/CD, GitOps with ArgoCD.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, OpenShift, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin, Django, SQL.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, stakeholder management, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance: GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation), Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · SANOMA LEARNING

